



**SRI LANKA INTERNATIONAL BUDDHIST
ACADEMY
DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

BSc in INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

PROJECT THESIS
FORMATTING AND SUBMISSION GUIDELINES**

For Final-Year Individual/Group IT Projects

Version 1.0

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Item	Details
Document Title	BSc IT Project Thesis Formatting and Submission Guidelines
Institution	Sri Lanka International Buddhist Academy (SIBA Campus)
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This guideline establishes a common academic and technical standard for the preparation, formatting, modelling, referencing, testing, and submission of BSc IT project theses. It is designed to complement the approved SIBA academic regulations, project handbook, assessment rubric, and supervisor instructions. Where an approved institutional regulation conflicts with this document, the institutional regulation takes precedence.

Purpose

- Provide one consistent thesis structure for BSc IT projects.
- Improve academic writing, technical documentation, and presentation quality.
- Standardize numbering, figures, tables, UML diagrams, references, appendices, and page layout.
- Ensure that project objectives, requirements, implementation, testing, and results can be traced.
- Provide a common reference for students, supervisors, examiners, and moderators.

Important Principle

Page count is a guideline rather than a substitute for academic quality. A shorter report may be acceptable when it adequately documents a focused project, while a longer report is not automatically better. The report must contain sufficient evidence to demonstrate the student's analysis, design, implementation, testing, evaluation, and contribution.

CONTENTS OF THIS GUIDELINE

1. General Thesis Requirements
2. Recommended Thesis Structure and Page Allocation
3. Front Matter
4. Chapter 1 – Introduction
5. Chapter 2 – Literature Review
6. Chapter 3 – Methodology and Requirements
7. UML and System Modelling Standards
8. Chapter 4 – System Design and Implementation
9. Chapter 5 – Testing, Results and Discussion
10. Chapter 6 – Conclusion and Future Work
11. Figures, Tables, Screenshots and Equations
12. Numbering and Cross-Referencing
13. Referencing and IEEE Citation Rules
14. Appendices
15. Academic Integrity, Ethics and Responsible AI Use
16. Recommended Microsoft Word Workflow
17. Final Submission Checklist
18. Appendix A – Recommended Thesis Template Structure
19. Appendix B – Suggested Requirement and Test Case Formats
20. Appendix C – Supervisor Quality Checklist

1. GENERAL THESIS REQUIREMENTS

1.1 Language

The thesis should be written in clear, formal academic English. Technical terms may be retained in their standard form. Avoid conversational language, unsupported claims, excessive first-person writing, and unnecessary repetition.

1.2 Paper and Page Layout

Element	Recommended Standard
Paper size	A4
Body font	Times New Roman, 12 pt
Line spacing	1.5
Alignment	Justified
Left margin	1.25–1.50 inches
Right margin	1.00 inch
Top margin	1.00 inch
Bottom margin	1.00 inch
Paragraph spacing	Approximately 6 pt after paragraphs
Chapter title	16 pt, bold
Section heading	14 pt, bold
Subsection heading	12 pt, bold
Body text	12 pt
Page numbering	Consistent; preliminary pages may use Roman numerals

These are departmental recommendations currently for the thesis template. If SIBA issues an approved institutional format with different values, students must follow the approved institutional format.

1.3 Recommended Main-Body Length

A recommended target for the main body is approximately 55–80 pages, excluding front matter, references, and appendices. This is not a mandatory page quota. The project must be documented according to its scope and complexity.

1.4 Numbering Hierarchy

- Chapter: CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION
- Section: 1.1 Background
- Subsection: 1.1.1 Context of the Problem
- Optional fourth level: 1.1.1.1 Existing Process
- Avoid unnecessary levels deeper than four levels.
- Do not use manual spaces or tabs to create numbering or alignment.

1.5 Recommended Page Numbering

- Preliminary pages may use lowercase Roman numerals: i, ii, iii, iv...
- The main thesis begins with Arabic page 1 at Chapter 1.
- References and appendices should continue the Arabic page numbering.
- Page numbers should be generated automatically by Microsoft Word.

2. RECOMMENDED THESIS STRUCTURE AND PAGE ALLOCATION

Section	Recommended Length / Treatment
Cover Page	1 page
Declaration	1 page
Supervisor Certification / Approval	1 page
Abstract	200–300 words; normally 1 page
Acknowledgement	½–1 page
Table of Contents	Automatic; length depends on report
List of Figures	Automatic
List of Tables	Automatic
List of Abbreviations	As required
Chapter 1 – Introduction	6–10 pages
Chapter 2 – Literature Review	10–15 pages
Chapter 3 – Methodology and Requirements	10–15 pages
Chapter 4 – Design and Implementation	15–25 pages
Chapter 5 – Testing, Results and Discussion	10–15 pages
Chapter 6 – Conclusion and Future Work	4–7 pages
References	As required; typically 3–8 pages
Appendices	As required

2.1 Mandatory Core Chapters

- Chapter 1: Introduction
- Chapter 2: Literature Review
- Chapter 3: Methodology and Requirements
- Chapter 4: System Design and Implementation

- Chapter 5: Testing, Results and Discussion
- Chapter 6: Conclusion and Future Work

2.2 Project-Type Adaptation

The exact contents should be adapted to the project type. For example, an AI/ML project may require dataset preparation, model architecture, training, validation and performance metrics; an IoT project may require hardware architecture, sensor specifications and deployment; a research-heavy project may require research questions, hypotheses, sampling and statistical analysis. Students should not insert irrelevant sections merely to satisfy a checklist.

3. FRONT MATTER

3.1 Cover Page

The cover page should contain, in the approved order:

21. Institution name.
22. Department name.
23. Project title.
24. Student name(s).
25. Registration number(s).
26. Degree programme.
27. Supervisor name.
28. Submission year.

3.2 Declaration

The declaration should confirm that the submitted work is the student's own work, that sources have been acknowledged, and that the work has not been submitted for another award. Use the department-approved wording where available.

3.3 Supervisor Certification / Approval

Include supervisor name, signature, date, and any required departmental approval fields. Do not alter an official approval format without authorization.

3.4 Abstract

The abstract should briefly state:

- The problem or context.
- The purpose/aim of the project.
- The approach or methodology.
- The system, model, prototype, or study developed.
- The main technologies/methods used.
- The most important findings or results.

- The main contribution and/or future direction.

Do not include citations, tables, detailed screenshots, or a long literature review in the abstract.

3.5 Acknowledgement

A concise acknowledgement may recognize supervisors, lecturers, organizations, participants, technical support, and family members. It should normally be limited to approximately one page.

3.6 Lists

- Table of Contents – mandatory and automatic.
- List of Figures – mandatory when figures are used.
- List of Tables – mandatory when tables are used.
- List of Abbreviations – recommended for projects using several abbreviations.
- List of Symbols – only when symbols/equations require it.

4. CHAPTER 1 – INTRODUCTION

Recommended length: approximately 6–10 pages.

1.1 Background

Introduce the domain, organizational or industry context, current situation, relevant technologies, and why the problem is important.

1.2 Problem Statement

Clearly define the existing problem. Explain the current process/situation, shortcomings, consequences, evidence, and the specific gap the project addresses.

1.3 Aim and Objectives

State one overall aim and a manageable set of measurable objectives. Specific objectives should use action verbs such as analyse, design, develop, implement, evaluate, validate, or compare.

1.4 Research Questions

Include where the project requires formal research questions. Questions should directly correspond to the problem and objectives.

1.5 Scope

Define what is included and excluded. Clearly identify users, modules, platforms, data, geographical/organizational boundaries, and major constraints.

1.6 Significance

Explain expected benefits and contributions to users, the organization, industry, society, or academic knowledge, as applicable.

1.7 Limitations

State genuine constraints that affect the project, such as time, data availability, hardware limitations, access restrictions, or prototype scope.

1.8 Organization of the Report

Provide a brief description of what each chapter contains.

4.1 Objective Quality Rule

Each objective should be assessable. At the end of the project, the student should be able to demonstrate whether each objective was achieved, partially achieved, or not achieved, with evidence.

5. CHAPTER 2 – LITERATURE REVIEW

Recommended length: approximately 10–15 pages.

2.1 Introduction

Define the purpose and scope of the review.

2.2 Theoretical / Conceptual Background

Explain concepts, models, frameworks, technologies, or theories needed to understand the project.

2.3 Domain and Technology Background

Discuss the technical/domain concepts that directly support the project.

2.4 Existing Systems / Related Work

Critically review relevant systems, studies, applications, algorithms, or approaches.

2.5 Comparison of Existing Systems

Compare important features, methods, limitations, technologies, and outcomes.

2.6 Research / Technology Gap

Identify what is missing, inadequate, inefficient, or unresolved in the existing work.

2.7 Proposed Contribution

Explain how the project addresses the identified gap.

2.8 Chapter Summary

Summarize the main findings and link them to the next chapter.

5.1 Literature Review Quality

- Use recent and authoritative academic sources where possible.

- Prefer peer-reviewed journal and conference papers, scholarly books, recognized standards, government publications, and official documentation.
- Do not use random websites as the main academic evidence.
- Do not copy literature review paragraphs directly from sources.
- Compare and synthesize sources rather than describing one source after another.
- Every externally derived factual or technical claim should be appropriately cited.

6. CHAPTER 3 – METHODOLOGY AND REQUIREMENTS

Recommended length: approximately 10–15 pages.

3.1 Introduction

Explain the chapter.

3.2 Research / Development Methodology

Describe the selected methodology and justify why it is appropriate.

3.3 Project Development Process

Show phases, activities, outputs, milestones, and iteration where applicable.

3.4 Requirement Elicitation

Explain how requirements were collected: interviews, observation, questionnaires, document analysis, stakeholder consultation, etc.

3.5 Functional Requirements

Document system functions with unique IDs such as FR-01, FR-02.

3.6 Non-Functional Requirements

Document quality attributes such as performance, security, usability, reliability, scalability, maintainability, and compatibility with unique IDs.

3.7 User Requirements

Summarize user roles, needs, permissions, and major interactions.

3.8 Hardware Requirements

List project-specific devices, sensors, controllers, computers, or other hardware.

3.9 Software Requirements

List operating systems, frameworks, programming languages, libraries, databases, development tools, and services.

3.10 Feasibility Analysis

Where appropriate, assess technical, operational, economic, and schedule feasibility.

3.11 System Modelling

Introduce UML, ERD, architecture and other models used.

3.12 Technologies Used

Justify important technology choices rather than only listing them.

3.13 Chapter Summary

Summarize the methodology and requirements.

6.1 Requirement Traceability

Projects should maintain traceability from objectives to requirements, design components, implementation modules, test cases, and results. This can be presented as a traceability matrix in Chapter 3 or an appendix.

Objective	Requirement	Module	Test Case	Evidence/Result
OBJ-01	FR-01	User Module	TC-01	Pass / evidence
OBJ-02	FR-05	Report Module	TC-08	Pass / evidence
OBJ-03	NFR-02	Security Module	TC-15	Pass / evidence

7. UML AND SYSTEM MODELLING STANDARDS

UML diagrams should follow the Unified Modeling Language specification. The Object Management Group (OMG) lists UML 2.5.1 as a formal version of the UML specification. Students should use UML 2.5.1 notation unless a later departmental standard is explicitly adopted.

Official OMG UML specification: <https://www.omg.org/spec/UML/>

7.1 Recommended UML Diagrams

Diagram	Recommendation	Purpose
Use Case	Strongly recommended	Shows actors and system functions.
Class	Strongly recommended	Shows classes, attributes, operations, and relationships.
Activity	Strongly recommended	Shows workflow and business/process logic.
Sequence	Strongly recommended	Shows interactions and message order for important scenarios.
Deployment	Project dependent	Shows physical/runtime deployment and communication.
Component	Project dependent	Shows software components and dependencies.
State Machine	Project dependent	Shows state changes of important objects.
Package	Project dependent	Shows organization of model elements.
ER Diagram	Database projects	Shows database entities, attributes, keys, and relationships; ERD is not a UML diagram.

7.2 Use Case Diagram Rules

- Actors represent external roles/entities interacting with the system.
- Use case names should describe actions, for example Manage Users or Generate Report.
- Show a clear system boundary.
- Use <<include>> only where behaviour is required and reused.

- Use <<extend>> for optional/conditional behaviour.
- Avoid one enormous diagram containing every use case when separate diagrams improve readability.
- Keep actors and relationships legible when printed.

7.3 Class Diagram Rules

- Use meaningful class names.
- Show relevant attributes and operations.
- Use visibility symbols where appropriate.
- Show relationship types and multiplicity when relevant.
- Use inheritance, aggregation, and composition only when conceptually justified.
- Keep implementation details that do not aid design out of the conceptual diagram.

7.4 Activity Diagram Rules

- Use initial and final nodes.
- Use action nodes for activities.
- Use decision/merge nodes for branching.
- Use guard conditions such as [Valid] and [Invalid].
- Use fork/join for meaningful parallel activity.
- Model a clearly defined workflow rather than the entire system at once.

7.5 Sequence Diagram Rules

- Use lifelines for actors/objects participating in the scenario.
- Show messages in correct chronological order.
- Use alt, opt, and loop fragments where they clarify alternatives or repetition.
- Create separate sequence diagrams for major use cases when necessary.
- The sequence diagram must agree with the actual implemented system.

7.6 ER Diagram Rules

- Identify entities and meaningful attributes.

- Clearly identify primary keys and foreign keys.
- Show cardinality and relationship constraints.
- Use a consistent ERD notation, preferably Crow's Foot for relational database projects.
- Ensure the ERD is consistent with the implemented database.

8. CHAPTER 4 – SYSTEM DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

Recommended length: approximately 15–25 pages.

4.1 Introduction

Introduce the design and implementation chapter.

4.2 System Architecture

Present and explain the overall architecture, layers, components, communication, and data flow.

4.3 System Components

Describe major hardware/software components.

4.4 Database Design

Explain schema, tables/collections, keys, relationships, normalization where applicable, and important design decisions.

4.5 User Interface Design

Explain design principles, navigation, important screens, responsiveness, accessibility, and validation.

4.6 Module Design

Describe each major module and its responsibility.

4.7 Algorithms / Models

For algorithmic or AI projects, explain algorithms, models, parameters, preprocessing, training, and decision logic.

4.8 Implementation

Explain how major requirements were implemented. Include selected code snippets only when they help explain a technical decision.

4.9 Security Implementation

Explain authentication, authorization, validation, data protection, secure storage, and relevant security controls.

4.10 Integration and Deployment

Explain integration among components and the deployment environment.

4.11 Chapter Summary

Summarize the implemented solution.

8.1 Screenshots

- Use screenshots to demonstrate important implemented functionality.
- Every screenshot must be referred to and explained in the text.
- Do not fill pages with screenshots without technical explanation.
- Remove passwords, API keys, tokens, personal information, and other confidential data.
- Use readable resolution and consistent cropping.

9. CHAPTER 5 – TESTING, RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Recommended length: approximately 10–15 pages.

5.1 Introduction

Explain the purpose of evaluation.

5.2 Testing Strategy

Explain test levels, environment, test data, and criteria.

5.3 Unit Testing

Test individual functions/components where appropriate.

5.4 Integration Testing

Test interactions among modules/components.

5.5 System Testing

Test the complete system against requirements.

5.6 User Acceptance Testing

Where appropriate, document user/stakeholder evaluation.

5.7 Functional Test Results

Present test cases, expected outcomes, actual outcomes, and pass/fail status.

5.8 Non-Functional Test Results

Evaluate performance, usability, security, reliability, compatibility, or other applicable qualities.

5.9 Performance / Model Evaluation

For AI/ML projects use appropriate metrics; for software systems use appropriate response-time, throughput, reliability, or resource metrics.

5.10 Comparison with Existing Systems

Compare the proposed system against relevant systems identified in the literature review.

5.11 Discussion

Interpret the results, explain implications, unexpected outcomes, strengths, and weaknesses.

5.12 Limitations

State limitations demonstrated or encountered during evaluation.

5.13 Chapter Summary

Summarize the main evaluation findings.

9.1 Test Case Format

Test ID	Requirement	Test Case	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
TC-01	FR-01	Register valid user	Account created	Account created	Pass
TC-02	FR-01	Register duplicate user	Error displayed	Error displayed	Pass
TC-03	FR-02	Login with valid credentials	Dashboard displayed	Dashboard displayed	Pass

9.2 Results versus Discussion

Results report what was observed or measured. Discussion interprets what those results mean and why they matter. Students should avoid presenting a number without explaining its significance.

9.3 AI/ML Evaluation

- Select metrics appropriate to the problem.
- Classification projects may use accuracy, precision, recall, F1-score, confusion matrix, ROC-AUC, or other justified measures.
- Regression projects may use MAE, MSE, RMSE, R^2 , or other justified measures.
- Explain dataset size, split strategy, preprocessing, validation approach, and relevant limitations.
- Do not fabricate evaluation results.

10. CHAPTER 6 – CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

Recommended length: approximately 4–7 pages.

6.1 Introduction

Introduce the conclusion chapter.

6.2 Summary of the Project

Summarize the problem, approach, implementation, and major results.

6.3 Achievement of Objectives

Explicitly state whether each objective was achieved, partially achieved, or not achieved, with evidence.

6.4 Key Findings

State the most important findings from testing/evaluation.

6.5 Contributions

Describe technical, practical, organizational, or academic contributions.

6.6 Limitations

Summarize important limitations without introducing unrelated issues.

6.7 Future Work

Propose realistic enhancements based on identified limitations or opportunities.

6.8 Conclusion

Provide a concise final statement about the value and outcome of the project.

Objective	Status	Evidence
OBJ-01	Achieved / Partially Achieved / Not Achieved	Module, test case, result
OBJ-02	Achieved / Partially Achieved / Not Achieved	Module, test case, result
OBJ-03	Achieved / Partially Achieved / Not Achieved	Evaluation evidence

11. FIGURES, TABLES, SCREENSHOTS AND EQUATIONS

11.1 Figure Numbering

Use chapter-based numbering with one sequence per chapter. Recommended format: Figure 1.1, Figure 1.2, Figure 2.1, Figure 3.1, etc. Avoid unnecessarily deep numbering such as Figure 3.4.1.

11.2 Figure Captions

Figure captions should appear **below figures center align**. Example: Figure 3.1: Use Case Diagram of the Proposed System.

11.3 Table Numbering

Use chapter-based numbering. Table captions should appear above tables. Example: Table 3.1: Functional Requirements.

11.4 Referencing Figures and Tables

- Every important figure/table must be referred to in the text.
- Use automatic cross-references where possible.
- Do not write 'the figure below' or 'the table above' as the only reference.
- Write: 'As shown in Figure 4.2...' or 'The requirements are summarized in Table 3.1...!'

11.5 External Figures

If an externally created figure is used, the source must be acknowledged and copyright/licensing requirements must be respected. Where possible, students should create original diagrams based on their analysis and cite the underlying source rather than reproducing an external figure.

11.6 Equations

Equations should be created using the Word Equation tool or another appropriate equation editor. Number equations only when they are referenced later, using a consistent format such as (1), (2), or chapter-based numbering if adopted.

12. NUMBERING AND CROSS-REFERENCING

12.1 What Should Be Automatically Numbered

- Chapters and headings
- Figures
- Tables
- Equations, where required
- Appendices
- Page numbers

12.2 Microsoft Word Cross-Reference Method

29. Apply Word Heading styles to all headings.
30. Insert figures and tables with References → Insert Caption.
31. Use References → Cross-reference when referring to a figure, table, section, or other numbered item.
32. Update fields before final submission using Ctrl+A followed by F9.
33. Update the Table of Contents, List of Figures, and List of Tables before producing the final PDF.

12.3 Avoid Manual Numbering

Manual numbering often causes broken references and incorrect contents pages when text moves. The supplied sample report contains an 'Error! Reference source not found.' entry, demonstrating why automatic cross-referencing should be required.

13. REFERENCING AND IEEE CITATION RULES

For BSc IT projects, the department recommends the IEEE numbered citation style unless an approved SIBA policy specifies another style. IEEE provides a formal reference guide for technical publications.

IEEE Reference Guide: <https://ieeauthorcenter.ieee.org/wp-content/uploads/IEEE-Reference-Guide.pdf>

13.1 In-Text Citations

- Use square-bracketed numbers, e.g., [1].
- Use [2], [5] when citing multiple non-consecutive sources.
- A source keeps the same reference number throughout the thesis.
- Reference numbers are assigned according to the order in which sources are first cited.
- Do not use author-year citations if the thesis is following IEEE style.

13.2 Reference List Rules

- Every source cited in the text must appear in the References section.
- Every reference listed must be cited somewhere in the thesis.
- Use complete bibliographic information.
- Include DOI where available for academic papers.
- For websites, include the page title, organization/author where available, access date, and URL according to the selected IEEE format.
- Use credible academic and authoritative sources whenever possible.

13.3 Example References

[1] A. Author and B. Author, "Title of article," Journal Name, vol. 10, no. 2, pp. 100–110, 2025.

[2] A. Author, "Title of conference paper," in Proc. International Conference Name, 2025, pp. 20–25.

[3] Organization Name, “Web page title,” Website Name. Accessed: Aug. 13, 2026.
[Online]. Available: <https://example.org>

[4] A. Author, Book Title, 3rd ed. City, Country: Publisher, 2024.

13.4 Source Quality

- Prefer peer-reviewed journal articles and conference papers for research claims.
- Use books for established concepts and theory.
- Use official standards for technical standards.
- Use official vendor documentation for software/API behaviour.
- Avoid using commercial or anonymous websites as the primary evidence for academic claims.

14. APPENDICES

Appendices contain supporting information that is useful for verification but would interrupt the flow of the main thesis.

14.1 Appendix Numbering

- Use APPENDIX A, APPENDIX B, APPENDIX C, etc.
- Each appendix should have a descriptive title.
- Do not continue Chapter 6 numbering into appendices.
- Appendices may contain their own internal headings, e.g., Appendix A.1, Appendix A.2, if necessary.

14.2 Suitable Appendix Material

- Detailed questionnaires/interview instruments
- Additional requirements
- Full test case lists
- Additional UML diagrams
- Database schema or SQL scripts
- Selected source code
- Additional screenshots
- User manual
- Deployment/configuration information
- Additional statistical outputs
- Consent/approval documentation where appropriate

14.3 Source Code

The thesis should not become a source-code dump. Include selected code snippets in the main report only when they help explain an implementation decision. Larger code listings may be placed in an appendix or supplied through an approved source-code repository.

15. ACADEMIC INTEGRITY, ETHICS AND RESPONSIBLE AI USE

15.1 Academic Integrity

- All submitted work must be the student's own work except where sources, collaborators, libraries, frameworks, or third-party components are explicitly acknowledged.
- Do not fabricate data, interviews, questionnaires, test results, evaluation results, references, or system performance.
- Do not copy text, diagrams, code, or other material without appropriate acknowledgement and permission where required.
- Students must comply with SIBA academic integrity and assessment policies.

15.2 Human Participants and Data

- Projects involving students, staff, customers, patients, or other human participants must follow applicable institutional requirements.
- Obtain appropriate consent where required.
- Protect personal and confidential information.
- Anonymize or pseudonymize data when appropriate.
- Do not expose passwords, API keys, tokens, personal identifiers, or confidential organizational information in the thesis.

15.3 Responsible Use of Generative AI

Generative AI tools may be used as permitted by SIBA policy for activities such as brainstorming, language support, debugging assistance, explanation, or preliminary research. Students remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, citations, implementation, testing, and conclusions in the submitted thesis.

- Do not submit fabricated AI-generated references.
- Do not fabricate research findings or test results using AI.
- Verify technical claims and citations independently.
- Disclose AI use when required by SIBA policy.

- Do not upload confidential or personal project data to public AI services without authorization.

16. RECOMMENDED MICROSOFT WORD WORKFLOW

16.1 Use Styles

- Heading 1 for chapter titles.
- Heading 2 for sections.
- Heading 3 for subsections.
- Heading 4 only when necessary.
- Normal for body text.
- Caption for figures and tables.

16.2 Automatic Contents

34. Apply styles to all headings.
35. Place the cursor where the Table of Contents should appear.
36. Select References → Table of Contents → Automatic Table.
37. Update the table after editing.

16.3 Final Update

38. Ctrl+A.
39. F9 to update fields.
40. Check the Table of Contents.
41. Check the List of Figures.
42. Check the List of Tables.
43. Check all cross-references.
44. Check page numbering.
45. Check spelling and grammar.
46. Export to PDF.
47. Open the final PDF and inspect every page before submission.

17. FINAL SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

17.1 Document Formatting

- ☐ A4 page size is used.
- ☐ Approved font and font sizes are used consistently.
- ☐ Margins are correct.
- ☐ Line spacing is consistent.
- ☐ Chapter and heading styles are consistent.
- ☐ Page numbering is correct.
- ☐ Table of Contents is updated.
- ☐ List of Figures is updated.
- ☐ List of Tables is updated.
- ☐ No blank or unintended pages remain.

17.2 Academic Content

- ☐ Problem statement is clear and evidence-based.
- ☐ Aim and objectives are clearly stated.
- ☐ Objectives are measurable and evaluated.
- ☐ Scope and limitations are defined.
- ☐ Literature review identifies a meaningful gap.
- ☐ Methodology is justified.
- ☐ Requirements are documented.
- ☐ System design is documented.
- ☐ Relevant UML/ERD diagrams are included.
- ☐ Implementation is explained.
- ☐ Testing is documented.
- ☐ Results are presented.
- ☐ Results are discussed and interpreted.
- ☐ Comparison with related work is included where relevant.
- ☐ Conclusion reflects the actual project outcome.
- ☐ Future work is realistic.

17.3 Figures and Tables

- ☐ Every figure has a caption.
- ☐ Every table has a caption.
- ☐ Figures and tables are numbered consistently.
- ☐ Figures and tables are referred to in the text.
- ☐ External sources are acknowledged.
- ☐ Images are readable when printed.
- ☐ No unnecessary screenshots are included.

17.4 References

- ☐ IEEE style is followed consistently.
- ☐ Every in-text citation appears in the reference list.
- ☐ Every listed reference is cited.
- ☐ Academic sources are used where appropriate.
- ☐ DOIs are included where available.
- ☐ Web references include access dates where required.
- ☐ No fabricated or unverifiable references are included.

17.5 Appendices

- ☐ Appendices use A, B, C numbering.
- ☐ Each appendix has a clear title.
- ☐ Appendix material is referenced from the main text where appropriate.
- ☐ Sensitive information has been removed.
- ☐ Source code is limited to useful/representative material.

APPENDIX A – RECOMMENDED THESIS TEMPLATE STRUCTURE

COVER PAGE

DECLARATION

SUPERVISOR CERTIFICATION / APPROVAL

ABSTRACT

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

TABLE OF CONTENTS

LIST OF FIGURES

LIST OF TABLES

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

1.2 Problem Statement

1.3 Aim and Objectives

1.3.1 Main Objective

1.3.2 Specific Objectives

1.4 Research Questions

1.5 Scope

1.6 Significance

1.7 Limitations

1.8 Organization of the Report

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

- 2.1 Introduction
- 2.2 Theoretical / Conceptual Background
- 2.3 Domain and Technology Background
- 2.4 Existing Systems / Related Work
- 2.5 Comparison of Existing Systems
- 2.6 Research / Technology Gap
- 2.7 Proposed Contribution
- 2.8 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER 3: METHODOLOGY AND REQUIREMENTS

- 3.1 Introduction
- 3.2 Research / Development Methodology
- 3.3 Project Development Process
- 3.4 Requirement Elicitation
- 3.5 Functional Requirements
- 3.6 Non-Functional Requirements
- 3.7 User Requirements
- 3.8 Hardware Requirements
- 3.9 Software Requirements
- 3.10 Feasibility Analysis
- 3.11 System Modelling
- 3.12 Technologies Used
- 3.13 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER 4: SYSTEM DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

- 4.1 Introduction
- 4.2 System Architecture
- 4.3 System Components
- 4.4 Database Design
- 4.5 User Interface Design
- 4.6 Module Design
- 4.7 Algorithms / Models
- 4.8 Implementation
- 4.9 Security Implementation
- 4.10 Integration and Deployment
- 4.11 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER 5: TESTING, RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

- 5.1 Introduction
- 5.2 Testing Strategy
- 5.3 Unit Testing
- 5.4 Integration Testing
- 5.5 System Testing
- 5.6 User Acceptance Testing
- 5.7 Functional Test Results
- 5.8 Non-Functional Test Results
- 5.9 Performance / Model Evaluation

5.10 Comparison with Existing Systems

5.11 Discussion

5.12 Limitations

5.13 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER 6: CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

6.1 Introduction

6.2 Summary of the Project

6.3 Achievement of Objectives

6.4 Key Findings

6.5 Contributions

6.6 Limitations

6.7 Future Work

6.8 Conclusion

REFERENCES

APPENDIX A – ...

APPENDIX B – ...

APPENDIX C – ...

APPENDIX B – SUGGESTED REQUIREMENT AND TEST CASE FORMATS

B.1 Functional Requirement Template

ID	Requirement	Priority	Source / Stakeholder	Acceptance Criteria
FR-01	The system shall allow ...	High	User/Admin	Valid action produces expected outcome.
FR-02	The system shall allow ...	Medium	Administrator	Specified data is saved and displayed.

B.2 Non-Functional Requirement Template

ID	Category	Requirement	Measure / Target
NFR-01	Performance	The system should respond within ...	$\leq$ X seconds
NFR-02	Security	Unauthorized users shall not access ...	Access denied
NFR-03	Usability	Users should complete ...	Defined success rate

B.3 Test Case Template

Test ID	Requirement ID	Precondition	Test Steps	Expected	Actual	Status
TC-01	FR-01	User registered	1. Login 2. Enter data 3. Submit	Record saved	Record saved	Pass
TC-02	FR-02	Duplicate data exists	Attempt duplicate entry	Validation error	Validation error	Pass

APPENDIX C – SUPERVISOR QUALITY CHECKLIST

Area	Review Question	Yes/No/NA	Comments
Problem	Is the problem clearly defined and justified?		
Objectives	Are objectives measurable and aligned with the problem?		
Literature	Does the review identify and justify a gap?		
Methodology	Is the selected methodology appropriate and justified?		
Requirements	Are functional and non-functional requirements documented?		
Design	Are architecture, database and relevant models consistent?		
UML	Do diagrams use appropriate UML notation and match the system?		
Implementation	Is implementation explained rather than merely shown?		
Testing	Is there sufficient evidence of systematic testing?		
Results	Are results measurable and credible?		
Discussion	Are results interpreted critically?		
Objectives	Does the conclusion explicitly evaluate objective achievement?		
References	Are citations and references complete and consistent?		
Integrity	Is originality, ethics and responsible AI use addressed?		
Presentation	Is the thesis professionally formatted and readable?		

REFERENCE SOURCES FOR THIS GUIDELINE

The following authoritative sources were consulted when establishing the UML and technical referencing guidance. The departmental page-count and chapter recommendations are departmental recommendations, not claims that these external standards prescribe a particular SIBA thesis length.

[1] Object Management Group, “About the Unified Modeling Language Specification Version 2.5.1,” OMG. Available: <https://www.omg.org/spec/UML/>

[2] IEEE, “IEEE Reference Guide,” IEEE Author Center. Available: <https://ieeeauthorcenter.ieee.org/wp-content/uploads/IEEE-Reference-Guide.pdf>

[3] Department of Information Technology, Sri Lanka International Buddhist Academy, “Thesis Sample of BSc IT,” provided as the source document for this guideline. The sample includes the cover/declaration, six-chapter structure, UML diagrams, references and appendices.

NOTE ON THE PROVIDED SAMPLE

The supplied sample thesis was used as the starting point for this guideline. It currently demonstrates a six-chapter structure, including Introduction, Literature Review, Methodology, System Design and Implementation, Results and Discussion, and Conclusion and Future Work. It also includes Use Case, Class, Activity, Sequence, Deployment and ER diagrams, references, and appendices. The new guideline expands and standardizes these elements for wider BSc IT use.